



Self Development Tracker

Business Requirements Document (BRD)

Version 1.0

SDT V1 - Local Application

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Document Control

Field	Details
Document Title	SDT - Business Requirements Document
Project	Self Development Tracker (SDT)
Version	1.0
Application Version	SDT V1 - Local Application
Date	26 August 2026
Status	Final
Purpose	Define the business need, scope, objectives, requirements, rules, constraints and success criteria for SDT V1.

1. Executive Summary

SDT (Self Development Tracker) was initially inspired by the concept of the 75-Hard challenge, a structured personal development program built around completing a defined set of daily commitments over a fixed period. The concept highlighted the value of consistency, accountability and measurable daily progress. However, a fixed set of rules did not fully accommodate different personal goals, schedules or levels of commitment.

SDT was therefore developed as a flexible, locally hosted self-development tracking application that allows users to create their own time-bound challenges, define the rules and tasks they want to follow, record daily completion and monitor their performance throughout the challenge. Rather than enforcing a predefined challenge structure, SDT allows the user to determine the challenge duration, daily commitments and permitted strikes before beginning.

The application provides a calendar-based dashboard, daily checklist, progress monitoring, per-rule strike tracking and progress/final reporting. Once a challenge begins, its rules are locked to maintain consistency and preserve the integrity of the challenge baseline.

2. Background and Business Need

Structured self-development challenges such as 75-Hard demonstrate how predefined daily commitments can create accountability and encourage consistency. However, individuals may want to apply the same principle to different goals without being restricted to a fixed duration or predefined set of rules.

Managing a customized challenge manually through notes, spreadsheets or memory can make it difficult to consistently record daily performance, distinguish unrecorded days from actual missed commitments, monitor individual rules and evaluate progress over time.

SDT addresses this problem by providing a centralized system for defining a personal challenge before it begins and systematically tracking daily adherence, progress and performance throughout the challenge.

3. Problem Statement

The user requires a single system for managing a time-bound self-development challenge. The system must reduce the effort involved in daily recording, preserve the distinction between missing data and actual non-compliance, provide clear visibility into adherence to individual rules, and summarise overall performance throughout and at the end of the challenge.

Without such a system, progress can be difficult to evaluate consistently, and the user may rely on subjective recollection (or pen-and-paper methods), rather than recorded evidence.

4. Project Objectives

- Provide a single location for defining and tracking a personal self-development challenge.
- Allow the user to configure the challenge name, start date, duration, strike allowance and daily rules before the challenge begins.
- Make daily recording quick and simple through a checklist-based user interface.
- Provide a calendar-based view that clearly communicates challenge dates, challenge day numbers and recorded completion.
- Provide an overall progress indicator for the challenge.
- Track missed rules using a configurable strike allowance without automatically restarting or terminating the challenge.
- Keep unrecorded days separate from recorded failures so that missing data is not incorrectly treated as non-compliance.
- Provide a progress report during an active challenge.
- Provide a final report when the challenge ends naturally or is ended manually.
- Preserve challenge records when a challenge is ended manually.
- Operate as a reliable local personal application without requiring cloud hosting for V1.

5. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / Interest	Key Responsibilities
Application Owner	Owns the product vision and determines how the challenge should operate.	Defines objectives, rules, priorities and acceptance expectations.
End User	Uses SDT to create and track personal challenges.	Configures a challenge, records daily adherence and reviews progress/reports.
Business Analyst	Translates the user need into structured requirements and system behaviour.	Defines requirements, business rules, workflows, traceability and acceptance criteria.
Developer / System Maintainer	Implements and maintains the application.	Builds frontend, API, database integration and resolves defects.

For SDT V1, these roles may be performed by the same individual. They are documented separately to make the responsibilities and perspectives explicit and to support future expansion of the product.

6. Scope

6.1 In Scope

- Create a new challenge through the frontend user interface.
- Configure challenge name, start date, duration and strike allowance.
- Add, remove and reorder daily rules/tasks before starting the challenge.
- Persist challenge configuration and rule data in the database when the challenge starts.
- Restrict challenge tracking to the configured challenge date range.
- Display challenge day number and total duration on valid calendar dates.
- Display dates outside the challenge period as disabled/non-interactive.
- Open a daily checklist from a valid calendar date.
- Provide a Today shortcut to open the current day's checklist when today falls within the active challenge.
- Allow the user to tick and untick rules/tasks and save the recorded day.
- Automatically refresh dashboard progress after a successful daily save.
- Calculate and display overall challenge progress.
- Calculate and display strikes used and strikes remaining for each rule.
- Treat strike limits as informational rather than punitive.
- Keep unrecorded days separate from recorded failed/missed rules.
- Generate an in-progress challenge report.
- Allow the user to manually end an active challenge with confirmation.
- Preserve challenge data when the challenge is manually ended.
- Generate a final report after manual or natural challenge completion.
- Support printing or saving reports through the browser's print functionality.
- Run locally on a Windows PC with Node.js, Express and Microsoft SQL Server.

6.2 Out of Scope for V1

- Public cloud deployment or internet hosting.
- Multi-user accounts and concurrent user support.
- User registration, login, password reset or role-based access control.
- Mobile-native iOS or Android applications.
- Social sharing, leaderboards or community features.
- Push notifications, email reminders or scheduled alerts.
- Integration with smart watches, fitness trackers or third-party health platforms.
- Automatic calorie, step or workout verification.
- Cloud backup and cross-device synchronisation.
- Administrative portal for managing multiple users.
- Public API access for third-party applications.

7. Business Requirements

ID	Area	Business Requirement	Priority
BR-01	Challenge Configuration	The user must be able to create a personalised, time-bound self-development challenge without modifying the database directly.	High
BR-02	Rule Definition	The user must be able to define the rules/tasks that will apply throughout the challenge before the challenge begins.	High
BR-03	Rule Stability	The challenge must preserve its configured rule set once started so that performance is measured against a consistent baseline.	High
BR-04	Daily Recording	The system must provide a simple method for recording whether each configured rule/task was followed or completed on a selected challenge day.	High
BR-05	Calendar Visibility	The user must be able to view the challenge period and daily progress through a calendar interface.	High
BR-06	Progress Monitoring	The user must be able to monitor overall challenge progress and recorded completion throughout the challenge.	High
BR-07	Strike Monitoring	The system must provide visibility into missed rules through a configurable strike allowance for each rule.	High
BR-08	Non-Punitive Strikes	Using all available strikes must not automatically restart, terminate or otherwise penalise the challenge.	High
BR-09	Unrecorded Day Treatment	An unrecorded day must remain distinguishable from a recorded failure and must not automatically consume strikes.	High
BR-10	Active Challenge Reporting	The user must be able to generate a report showing how the active challenge is progressing.	High
BR-11	Challenge Completion Reporting	The system must provide a final report when the challenge reaches its end or is manually ended.	High
BR-12	Manual Completion	The user must be able to manually end an active challenge after confirming the action.	Medium
BR-13	Historical Preservation	Ending a challenge must preserve its challenge configuration and recorded performance data.	High
BR-14	Local Operation	SDT V1 must operate as a local personal application without requiring external hosting or cloud database services.	Medium
BR-15	Usability	Routine daily use must require minimal navigation and should support direct access to today's checklist.	High

8. Business Rules

Rule ID	Business Rule
BRULE-01	Only one challenge may be active at a time in SDT V1.
BRULE-02	Challenge rules/tasks are defined before the challenge starts and are treated as locked for the duration of that challenge.
BRULE-03	Only dates from the configured challenge start date through the calculated challenge end date are valid tracking dates.
BRULE-04	Dates before the challenge start and after the challenge end are displayed as unavailable and cannot be used to record challenge progress.
BRULE-05	A recorded day stores the completion state of each configured rule/task for that day.
BRULE-06	A perfect day is a recorded day on which every configured rule/task is marked complete.
BRULE-07	A missed rule on a recorded day contributes one strike to that rule.
BRULE-08	An unrecorded day does not automatically count as a failed day and does not automatically consume strikes.
BRULE-09	The configured strike allowance applies independently to each rule.
BRULE-10	When strikes used reach or exceed the configured allowance, the challenge continues. No automatic restart, termination or other penalty is applied.
BRULE-11	The Today shortcut may open the daily checklist only when the current date falls within the active challenge period.
BRULE-12	Manual challenge termination requires user confirmation.
BRULE-13	Manual challenge termination preserves previously stored challenge and daily progress data.
BRULE-14	A final report is available when the challenge is completed naturally or manually.

9. High-Level User Journey

The intended SDT V1 user journey is:

1. Launch SDT locally.
2. If no active challenge exists, configure a new challenge.
3. Define challenge settings and daily rules/tasks.
4. Start the challenge, which persists the configuration and locks the challenge baseline.
5. Use the dashboard to view calendar position, overall progress and strikes.
6. Open a valid date or use the Today shortcut.
7. Tick or untick the tasks completed and rules followed, then save.
8. Review updated calendar completion, overall progress and strikes.
9. Generate a progress report when a mid-challenge review is required.
10. Continue until the challenge reaches its natural end or manually end it.
11. Review and print/save the final report.
12. Return to the setup screen to begin another challenge when desired.

10. Data and Reporting Requirements

10.1 Core Data

- Challenge identity and name.
- Challenge start date, configured duration and calculated end date.
- Strike allowance per rule.
- Challenge status and completion information.
- Configured rules/tasks and their display order.
- Daily recorded completion state for each rule/task.
- Recorded versus unrecorded day status.
- Derived strike usage and remaining strike allowance.
- Derived daily, overall and rule-level performance measures.

10.2 Progress Report

The active challenge report should provide sufficient information for the user to understand current performance, including:

- Current challenge position/day.
- Recorded days and unrecorded days.
- Perfect days.
- Average recorded completion.
- Completed and missed task counts.
- Strike usage.
- Strongest and weakest rule where sufficient data exists.

- Rule-level performance.
- Daily performance.

10.3 Final Report

The final report should summarise the completed challenge using the stored challenge configuration and recorded performance. It must remain meaningful whether the challenge ended naturally or was manually ended.

11. Non-Functional Requirements

ID	Category	Requirement
NFR-01	Usability	The interface should allow routine daily recording with minimal steps and clear labels.
NFR-02	Performance	Normal local dashboard, checklist and report operations should respond without noticeable delay under expected single-user data volumes.
NFR-03	Reliability	A successful save must persist the selected daily task states before the day dialog closes.
NFR-04	Data Integrity	Challenge, task and daily status records must maintain valid relationships in the database.
NFR-05	Maintainability	Frontend, backend/API and database concerns should remain separated sufficiently to support future changes.
NFR-06	Security	Database credentials must be stored outside source control using environment configuration.
NFR-07	Compatibility	V1 is intended for a modern desktop browser on a Windows PC with the required local runtime and database components.
NFR-08	Recoverability	Stored challenge data should remain available after stopping and restarting the Node.js application, provided the database is not reset or removed.

12. Assumptions

- The primary V1 user is comfortable operating SDT on a Windows computer after completing the installation guide.
- Node.js and Microsoft SQL Server are installed and functioning correctly.
- The SDT database is available when the application is started.
- The user records progress honestly; SDT does not independently verify physical activities or behavioural commitments.
- The user understands that strike tracking is informational and not an automatic enforcement mechanism.
- Only one active challenge is required at a time.
- The challenge's configured rules remain appropriate for the full challenge period once started.
- The browser's print functionality is sufficient for printing or saving reports as PDF in V1.

13. Constraints

- V1 is local-only and therefore is not directly accessible from another device without additional deployment/network configuration.
- V1 is single-user and does not provide authentication or data isolation between multiple users.
- The application depends on the local Node.js runtime and Microsoft SQL Server service being available.
- Initial installation requires database and environment configuration.

- The database setup/reset script is destructive when intentionally used to rebuild the SDT database.
- Core V1 data is stored locally; cloud backup and synchronisation are not provided.
- Public deployment would require additional architecture and security decisions that are outside the V1 scope.

14. Dependencies

Dependency	Purpose
Node.js / npm	Runs the application server and installs project dependencies.
Express	Provides the backend HTTP/API layer.
Microsoft SQL Server	Provides persistent local relational data storage.
SQL Server Management Studio (SSMS)	Supports initial database setup and local database administration.
Modern Web Browser	Provides the user interface and report printing capability.
Environment Configuration (.env)	Provides local server/database configuration without hard-coding credentials in source control.

15. Risks and Mitigations

ID	Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
R-01	Local installation is too complex for a non-technical tester.	Medium	Medium	Provide a detailed installation guide and one-click batch launcher. Consider hosted deployment as a future enhancement.
R-02	User accidentally executes the database reset script and loses stored challenge data.	High	Low	Clearly document that the setup script is destructive and should only be used for initialisation or intentional reset.
R-03	Database credentials are exposed through source control.	High	Low	Use <code>`.env`</code> , provide <code>`.env.example`</code> , and exclude the real <code>`.env`</code> from Git.
R-04	User forgets to record a day, causing incomplete progress data.	Medium	Medium	Keep unrecorded days explicitly separate from failed days and show them in reporting.
R-05	Strike logic is interpreted as a mandatory challenge restart.	Medium	Low	Define strikes as informational only and display this clearly in the interface.
R-06	Local SQL Server service is unavailable when SDT launches.	Medium	Medium	Document service/database troubleshooting and provide clear application errors.
R-07	V1 is shared publicly without authentication.	High	Low	Keep V1 local-only. Treat authentication and public deployment as future-scope architecture work.

16. Success Criteria and Acceptance Measures

ID	Acceptance Measure
SC-01	A user can configure and start a challenge entirely through the frontend without manually editing database records.
SC-02	The configured challenge dates and day numbers are displayed correctly on the calendar.
SC-03	Dates outside the challenge period cannot be used to record challenge data.
SC-04	The user can record and later edit a valid day's checklist.
SC-05	After a successful save, the dashboard reflects the updated daily completion, overall progress and strike information.
SC-06	Unrecorded days do not automatically consume strikes or count as recorded failures.
SC-07	Missed rules on recorded days are reflected accurately in strike calculations.

SC-08	Exhausting the strike allowance does not automatically restart or terminate the challenge.
SC-09	The Today shortcut opens today's checklist when today is within the active challenge.
SC-10	The progress report accurately summarises the active challenge using stored data.
SC-11	The user can manually end the challenge only after confirmation and existing data remains preserved.
SC-12	A final report is produced for a naturally or manually completed challenge.
SC-13	Stopping and restarting the application does not remove previously stored challenge data.

17. Future Considerations (Outside V1 Baseline)

The following items are potential future enhancements rather than approved V1 requirements. They should be assessed through change management before implementation:

- Hosted/cloud deployment to reduce local installation effort.
- Migration from local SQL Server to a managed cloud database where appropriate.
- User authentication and private per-user data ownership.
- Multi-user support.
- Cross-device access and synchronisation.
- Automated reminders or notifications.
- Challenge templates.
- Historical challenge comparison and trend analytics.
- Exportable data and richer reporting.
- Responsive/mobile-first interface enhancements.
- Third-party fitness or productivity integrations.

18. Requirements Governance and Change Control

This BRD represents the agreed baseline for SDT V1. Any change that materially affects scope, business rules, data handling, user access, deployment architecture or reporting should be evaluated as a change request rather than silently added to the V1 baseline.

A future change request should record the source of the request, problem or opportunity, proposed change, affected requirements, impacted system components, risks, priority and acceptance criteria. This approach supports traceability between stakeholder feedback and product evolution.

19. Requirements Traceability Preparation

The business requirements in this document will serve as parent requirements for the subsequent Functional Requirements Specification and Requirements Traceability Matrix. Detailed functional requirements should reference the relevant BR identifier, and test cases should ultimately trace back through the functional requirement to the originating business need.

Example traceability chain:

BR-09 → Functional Requirement → Business Rule → Test Case → Test Result

20. Approval / Baseline

Baseline Status: Approved

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